Selling Airport Dynasty Pro on PC

Code signing certificates, store options and realistic sales expectations · compiled 12 November 2026

In short: nobody sells signing certificates for a fee per sale; stores are the per-sale option. Steam, Epic and the Microsoft Store need no certificate. For your own installer and website downloads, the cheapest certificate you can get from the Faroe Islands is Certum's Standard Code Signing in the Cloud, at roughly €50–€210 a year. It pays for itself after about 4 to 15 sales a year at around €20.

1 · Code signing certificate (for your own installer)

Microsoft's Artifact Signing (formerly Trusted Signing), about $10 a month: not available to you

Microsoft's own service is the cheapest, but public-trust certificates are only available to organizations in the USA, Canada, the EU and the UK, and to individual developers in the USA and Canada. The Faroe Islands are not in the EU, and you would be applying as an individual, so it is out of reach for now.

Cheapest real option: Certum (Poland)

- Product: **Standard Code Signing in the Cloud**. The key is kept in Certum's cloud (the SimplySign app), so there is no USB token.
- Individuals can buy it; a copy of your passport is enough for identity checks.
- Price: Certum's shop lists it from €49 on one page and from €209 on another, so check at checkout. Resellers list it at about $120 a year.
- Since March 2026 certificates are valid for a shorter time, so plan to renew every year.
- Other options: Sectigo or Comodo individual certificates at about $219 a year, or the FastSSL (DigiCert) certificate at about $149 a year.

Good to know: a standard (OV) certificate removes the "Unknown publisher" warning, but Windows SmartScreen may still warn people for the first weeks. That warning fades as more people download the signed game.

Your own custom installer

- Fully possible. Build the installer any way you like (Inno Setup, for example, is free and allows commercial use), then sign both the installer and the game's .exe with the certificate.
- It can install over the old version and raise the version number with every release.

2 · Paying per sale instead: the stores

Store	Cut per sale	Certificate needed?	Notes

Steam	30% (lower above certain revenue levels)	No	$100 fee per game, refunded once the game earns $1,000
Epic Games Store	12%	No	Epic Games Store sales don't count towards Unreal's 5% royalty
Microsoft Store (MSIX package)	12% for games	No, Microsoft signs it free	Free registration for individuals; free hosting and automatic updates; the Store installs the game, so no custom installer
Microsoft Store (your own EXE/MSI)	12% for games	Yes, you sign it yourself	Lets you keep your own installer

Recommended setup: sell through Steam and the Microsoft Store (MSIX, free signing). Buy one Certum certificate only when you also offer your own installer or website downloads.

3 · Will it sell enough?

The certificate: very likely yes

At around €20 a copy, you keep about €14 after Steam's 30%. Selling 4 to 15 copies a year covers a €50–€210 certificate. Store sales need no certificate at all, so buy it only once sales are coming in.

"Plenty" of sales: not guaranteed

Figures for games released on Steam in 2025:

- About 66% of games earned less than $1,000; only about 10% earned $50,000 or more.
- Nearly half (47.5%) sold fewer than 100 copies.
- Only about 300 of roughly 20,000 releases (1.5%) earned over $1 million.
- Median revenue for paid games released in 2026 so far: about $1,728.

These figures include many quick, low-effort games, so a polished, deep Unreal management sim starts well above the average. But wishlists and visibility, not quality alone, decide sales.

What makes the difference

- Put the Steam page up early, many months before launch, and collect wishlists. About 10,000 by launch day is the usual target.
- Make a playable demo and enter Steam Next Fest.
- Post short clips of the strongest visuals on TikTok, YouTube and Reddit (r/tycoon, r/AirportCEO, r/flightsim). Good candidates: the Lumen terminal, crowds with daily lives, jetways docking, the globe.
- Aim at the niche: a realistic airport-CEO game with Unreal-quality graphics has a real audience among airport-sim fans.

Sources

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